

Why's it even called an OS?

If you know people who've tried Linux, you may have heard them lament: "It doesn't let me install Microsoft Word, doesn't play my games or music from my library, looks different, 'My Computer' is missing, and how do I even dial up using my modem?" The problem with the Linux distributions in those days was that they didn't fit the technology landscape we were all so used to. The number of devices were increasing and there were very few tools which actually worked.

Found lacking in many key features

SuSE 9.1, given away by Digit, didn't have mp3 playback capability, which put off many potential long-term users. The office suite 'Open Office' bundled with Linux distros was rudimentary, to say the least. It didn't support many of the features expected by regular users and this was another major setback. Another thing that bothered a lot of people were the unstable drivers. A majority of computers didn't sport a dedicated graphics card and the on-board graphics drivers weren't stable in a number of cases. Though kernel panics weren't common, nothing seemed to work out of the box.



Overwhelming amount of details for trivial tasks is the first thing that puts new users off. This is probably where Ubuntu got it right